

George R. Chichirau, Ph. D.

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Summary

- **Policy Research Analyst - Supervisor** with ample experience in quantitative research;
- **Experienced Lecturer in Public Policy, Economics and Quantitative Techniques**, with teaching experience at Northeastern University, UMass Boston, and Suffolk University;
- **Co-author of a public policy textbook** ([Public Policymaking](#)) and **an urban development textbook** ([Supporting Shrinkage: Better Planning and Decision-Making for Legacy Cities](#));
- **Statistician** with experienced in managing and analysing large datasets, applying advanced methods (regression, time series, sampling/forecasting, econometric modelling, and anomaly detection), and building dashboards (e.g. in Tableau) to support senior decision-makers.

Work Experience

Office of the Massachusetts State Auditor | 1 Ashburton Pl, Boston, MA 02108

Policy Research Supervisor | Oct 01 2021 – present

Strategic Policy Initiatives: Led reviews of state programs across transportation, energy, education, intergovernmental aid, and municipal finance, assessing funding flows, statutory constraints, operational patterns, and policy impacts for senior decision-makers.

Executive Decision Support: Produced briefings, memos, talking points, reports, website copy, FAQs, and recommendations that translated complex policy, fiscal, and operational issues into clear materials for leadership and public release.

Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis: Built Stata models and Tableau dashboards, used MaxQDA for qualitative work, and delivered regression, time-series, sampling, forecasting, and anomaly-detection analyzes to support program reviews and evidence-based policy decisions.

Cross-Agency Coordination: Coordinated with municipal and state officials, internal investigative teams, and senior elected leaders to gather input, structure evidence reviews, present findings, and support follow-up on report recommendations.

Program Improvement & Governance: Advised the Director of the Division of Local Mandates on statewide and local budgetary strategies, policies, practices, and follow-up options, helping connect findings to practical implementation paths.

Analytical Tools: Used Stata, Tableau, Excel, MaxQDA, R, Python, SQL, ArcGIS, Microsoft 365 and more to strengthen data quality, reporting, and decision support.

Northeastern University | 360 Huntington Ave, Boston, MA 02115

Lecturer | Sep 01 2020 – present

Researched and developed innovative, community-focused planning methods and technologies for cities facing decline, incorporating collaborative planning, social media, and civic tech. Evaluated analytic approaches for policy design in shrinking cities, emphasizing economic development and local empowerment through case studies. Advocated for data-driven, tech-centered decision-making, using new technologies to empower residents in urban transformation.

My teaching history includes:

- INSH 6500: Statistical Analysis. Studies the use of social science quantitative techniques, emphasizing applications of value to public-sector analysts and scholars alike. Introduces probability and statistical analysis.
- POLS 2400: Quantitative Techniques. Methods of quantitative analysis including descriptive statistics, hypothesis testing, cross-tabulation, analysis of variance, bivariate regression and correlation, and multiple regression. Examines how to generate and interpret statistical findings through use of Stata. Uses examples from political behavior, public policy analysis, public opinion, comparative and international politics, and other areas of political and social-science inquiry to emphasize practical applications.
- POLS 2358: Current Issues in Cities and Suburbs. An in-depth introduction to pressing urban issues: urban sprawl, poverty, education, transportation, economic development, and housing, through an intensive analysis of the Boston area.
- POLS 2357: Growth and Decline of Cities and Suburbs. Students explore the roles of individuals, communities, the private sector, and government in planning and shaping the city.

University of Massachusetts (McCormack Graduate School of Policy)

Lecturer | Sep 01 2017 – present

My teaching history includes:

- PUBADM 602: A study of the economic and fiscal structure of Massachusetts vis-a-vis New England and the nation. The latter part of the course focuses on the economics of major issues facing policy makers. Such issues include public and private housing, health care costs, public pensions, fiscal and economic competitiveness, and the economics of the capital city, Boston.
- ECON 395: This class examines social welfare in the US, what causes poverty, and solutions to poverty, as well as how the US compares to other countries. It provides tools to evaluate social welfare and poverty programs and examines major economic security programs in the United States, such as Social Security and Temporary Assistance to Needy Families.
- UPCD 620: Analytic Methods for Urban Planning (graduate). An introduction to quantitative and qualitative analytic methods appropriate to propose, support and evaluate localized and

regional initiatives in planning and community development. Students use Stata to manage large datasets and produce descriptive summaries, plots, and inferential analyses (including regression).

The Expert TA/OpenStax | *Remote*

Subject Matter Expert/Assessment Author (Contract) | **July 2025 – present**

Developed multiple-choice questions for college textbooks (e.g. [American Government 3e](#)) aligned to chapter learning objectives and Bloom's taxonomy; provided correct answers, hints, brief rationales. Collaborated asynchronously with editors via CMS/shared docs; maintained quality and accuracy across rapid review cycles.

Suffolk University | *73 Tremont St, Boston, MA 02108*

Lecturer | **Sep 01 2024 – April 30 2025**

Teaching history:

- POLS-181: Comparative Politics. Introduces various approaches of comparative politics, such as institutionalism, structuralism, political culture, corporatism, state-society relationship, political economy, etc. Applies these frameworks to analyze policymaking processes and governance structures within the European Union, including the role of the European Commission, inter-institutional dynamics, and policy implementation. Examines EU institutions comparatively alongside the US and China, highlighting distinct mechanisms of policy coordination, strategic planning, and stakeholder engagement.
- POLS-223: American Politics & Institutions. This course provides an examination of the institutions involved in the American policy-making process. The students learn about the presidential system, the relationship between the President and Congress and how that relationship impedes or facilitates the public policy process, including the budgetary process. Much attention is also given to the role of the judiciary in the policy process.

INFORMS (The Institute for Operations Research and Management Sciences)

Research Project Manager | **part-time** | **Jan 01 2018 – Jan 31 2020**

Managed the [INFORMS Editor's Cut edition on diversity issues](#). Proposed relevant papers, integrated the collection with papers proposed by other committee members, and saw it through to final product. Developed a diversity knowledge base: established technical standards, performed a wide-ranging review, collected and published materials etc.

University of Massachusetts (McCormack Graduate School of Policy)

Graduate Research Assistant | **part-time** | **Sep 01 2015 – May 30 2020**

- Dissertation research on public transit funding: I examined to what extent the MBTA could transition from a revenue stream dependent on budgetary allocations to one dependent on

real estate. This included spatial and econometric modeling of the likely economic and social consequences of the MBTA functioning under different financing models.

- I contributed to 4 publications; I notably wrote chapter 2 of “Supporting Shrinkage: Better Planning and Decision-Making for Legacy Cities”, a quantitative analysis of how data and technologies can support sustainable and equitable urban planning in legacy cities (and did most of the data analysis for the entire volume).
- I worked on the Public Administration Master’s Program marketing in the following areas: 1) data analysis of enrollment and financial trends; 2) market analysis of comparable programs across the US; 3) lead development; and 4) social media development.

Wellington Solar LLC

Project Manager | Jan 01 2014 – August 31 2015

Re-designed the company web site, implemented a major IT systems upgrade, and re-tooled the marketing portfolio.

BRIO Local Ltd.

Director of Legal Affairs | November 15 2010 - Dec 31 2013

BRIO Local was a consulting group that facilitated transactions between Central European and Chinese companies (mostly subcontracting of manufacturing and purchases of raw materials). My role within BRIO was to identify optimal outcomes and draft agreements.

House of Romeo School of Foreign Languages (Shenzhen, China)

General Manager | Sep 01 2007 - October 31 2010

Started this school of foreign languages to meet growth opportunities in the Chinese education market. I designed the course structures and scheduling; recruited a 15-person team; found a physical location, devised and implemented a marketing plan. The language center grew to be financially sound and self-sustaining by 2010.

Carleton College Student Association (Northfield, MN)

Senator | 2006 - 2007

Debated \$400,000/year budget allocations with 18 fellow senators.

Education

- University of Massachusetts (Boston) – Ph.D. in Public Policy
- University of Massachusetts (Boston) – M.S. in Public Policy
- Carleton College — B.A. (Magna Cum Laude) in Political Science and Classical Studies

Technical Skills

- Core competencies: program evaluation, statistical analysis, data collection and aggregation, contract/vendor oversight, public reporting, plain-language communications, stakeholder coordination, instructional content design;
- Tools: Stata, Tableau, Excel, SQL, R, MaxQDA, ArcGIS, Microsoft 365, Monday.com, Otter.ai, AI-assisted workflow tools, AI agentic deployment (OpenClaw/Hermes);
- Languages: English, Romanian, French; working knowledge of Portuguese.

Selected Publications

Chichirau G. 2025. [Who Pays and Who Gains? Analyzing Contributors and Beneficiaries of the Mass Save Program](#). Office of the Massachusetts State Auditor.

Chichirau G. 2024. [Assessing Transportation Network Companies' Financial Obligations to Massachusetts Programs](#). Office of the Massachusetts State Auditor.

Anderson, J., Moyer, J., Chichirau, G. 2023. [Public Policymaking \(9th Edition\)](#). Cengage Learning.

Johnson, Michael P., Hollander, J., Kinsey, E., Chichirau, G. 2021. [Supporting Shrinkage: Better Planning and Decision-Making for Legacy Cities](#). Albany, NY: SUNY University Press.

Tafoya B., DeBarcelos C., Chichirau G. & Hershman H. 2022. [Five-Year Statutory Fiscal Impact Report 2022](#). Office of the Massachusetts State Auditor.

Tafoya B., DeBarcelos C., Chichirau G. & Hershman H. 2022. [Fulfilling the Promise of Local Aid by Strengthening State-Local Partnerships](#). Office of the Massachusetts State Auditor.

Midgley, G., Johnson, M. P., & Chichirau, G. (2018). [What is Community Operational Research?](#) European Journal of Operational Research, 268(3), 771–783.

Johnson, M. P., Midgley, G., & Chichirau, G. (2018). [Emerging Trends and New Frontiers in Community Operational Research](#). European Journal of Operational Research, 268(3), 1178–1191.

Johnson, M. P., Midgley, G., Wright, J., & Chichirau, G. (2018). [Community Operational Research: Innovations, internationalization and agenda-setting applications](#). EJOR, 268(3).